Rasid M. Paca

Dr. Rasid M. Paca (also referred to as **Rashid M. Paca**), RME, JD, DPA, is a longtime Filipino academic administrator, educator, and institutional leader who has spent over three decades building his career within the Mindanao State University (MSU) System, based primarily in Marawi City. He is known for wearing many hats throughout his professional life, moving fluidly between engineering, agriculture, law, and public administration, and using that broad foundation to serve MSU through some of its most difficult chapters, including the aftermath of the 2017 Marawi Siege and the disruptions of the COVID-19 pandemic. Much of what is publicly known about him comes from official MSU sources, institutional announcements, and public records, since he has generally kept his personal life out of the spotlight even as his professional profile grew within the university system.

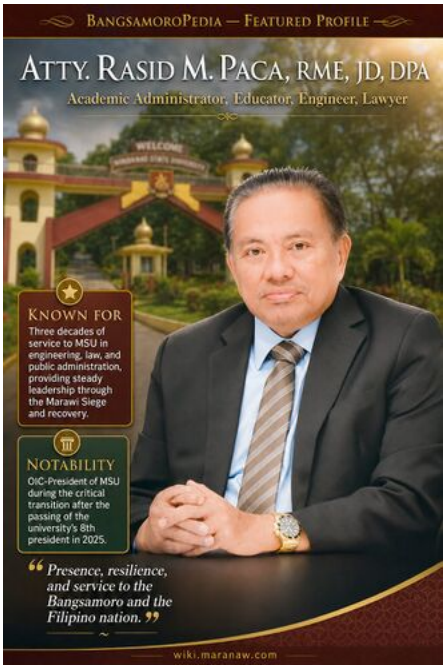
Contents

1 Early Life and Education
2 Career at Mindanao State University
3 OIC Presidency (2025)
4 Public Engagement and Contributions
5 Legacy
6 See Also
7 References

Early Life and Education

Details about Dr. Paca's early life, including his exact birth date and family background, are not extensively documented in publicly available materials, a reflection of how private he has remained even as his career in academic administration flourished. What is well recorded is his academic journey, which reads like a study in lifelong learning. He earned his Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering from Mindanao State University in Marawi City back in 1989, laying the technical foundation that would later distinguish him among his peers in university leadership. He returned to the classroom repeatedly over the following decades. In 1996, he completed a Certificate in Governmental Management at MSU. By 2001, he had earned a Master of Science in Agricultural Engineering from the University of the Philippines Los Baños, where he studied as an APDP Scholar. He did not stop there. In 2007, he obtained his Bachelor of Laws (LLB) from MSU Marawi, adding legal expertise to his growing set of credentials. He later pursued a Doctor in Public Administration (DPA) at MSU, completing it in 2021, and around 2004 he also earned units toward a Ph.D. in Sustainable

Dr. Rasid M. Paca



Also Known As

Rashid M. Paca

Credentials

RME, JD, DPA

Occupation

Academic Administrator, Educator, Engineer, Lawyer

Institution

Mindanao State University (MSU) System

Notable Role

Officer-in-Charge (OIC) President, MSU System (May 27, 2025 to June 27, 2025)

Alma Mater

Mindanao State University, Marawi City; University of the Philippines Los Baños

Notability

Served as Officer-in-Charge President of the MSU System during a critical leadership transition following the passing of the university's 8th president in 2025

Known For

Over three decades of multidisciplinary service to MSU spanning engineering, law, and public administration, and steady institutional leadership through the Marawi Siege and its recovery

Pull Quote

"Presence, resilience, and service to the Bangsamoro and the Filipino nation."

Development at MSU Iligan City. Alongside all this, Dr. Paca holds the distinction of being a Registered Mechanical Engineer (RME). Early in his career, before his long tenure at MSU took full shape, he worked as a technical instructor at a Qatar Independent Technical School and later served as founding president of the Philippine Engineering and Agro-Industrial College, Inc. (PEACI), an engineering focused institution in Marawi City. This combination of engineering, agriculture, law, and public administration would go on to shape how he approached university leadership: practical, grounded, and always attentive to sustainable development and good governance.

Career at Mindanao State University

Dr. Paca's relationship with MSU spans more than thirty years, and it shows in the steady progression of roles he has held. He started out as a faculty member and moved through the ranks as department chairperson, then college dean, then Vice President for Planning and Development, and eventually Executive Vice President, one of the highest administrative posts in the university system. Along the way, he frequently stepped in as Officer-in-Charge whenever the university president was away on official travel, a role that quietly built the institutional trust that would later matter a great deal. During his time in these positions, he became closely associated with MSU's recovery efforts following the Marawi Siege, working on partnerships such as the one with the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) for humanitarian and educational initiatives in the aftermath of the conflict. He was also active in community engagement work and in promoting integrity and national loyalty within the university, themes that came up often in his public statements.

OIC Presidency (2025)

The most defining chapter of Dr. Paca's career so far came in 2025. Following the passing of the MSU System's 8th President, Atty. Basari D. Mapupuno, in May of that year, the MSU Board of Regents designated Dr. Paca as Officer-in-Charge (OIC) President. He held this interim post from May 27, 2025 to June 27, 2025, guiding the university system through a sensitive leadership transition before formally turning over the presidency to the 9th president, Atty. Paisalin P.D. Tago, CPA, in early July 2025. It was a short stretch as caretaker leader, but a significant one. During this period, he met with President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. in Marawi City in June 2025, where discussions touched on rehabilitation efforts, agro-fishery projects, and MSU's broader role in regional development across Mindanao. MSU communications from this period describe his leadership style as one built on presence and resilience, qualities that had already been tested through crises like the Marawi Siege and the pandemic, and that carried over into his brief but consequential time at the helm.

Public Engagement and Contributions

Beyond his formal administrative roles, Dr. Paca has been a visible presence in efforts tied to MSU's broader mission as an institution for education, peace-building, and development in Mindanao. He has taken part in events centered on cultural unity, sustainable practices, and community resilience, consistently framing his public statements around integrity, the rejection of corruption, and service to both the Bangsamoro people and the wider Filipino nation. His official MSU profile notes that detailed lists of publications, research projects, or specific courses taught are still being compiled, marked as "updating soon" in available institutional records. No significant controversies or conflicting accounts have surfaced in official or reputable sources reviewed for this article.

Legacy

In the broader story of Philippine higher education, especially within Mindanao, figures like Dr. Paca represent something important: continuity. His multidisciplinary background, spanning engineering, law, agriculture, and public administration, has equipped him to navigate a region where academic excellence has to coexist with socio-economic challenges and peace-related priorities. As of mid-2025, he continues to serve MSU in a senior capacity, carrying forward decades of institutional knowledge at a university system that has weathered no shortage of storms. Further primary materials, such as a full curriculum vitae, archival university records, or in-depth interviews, could add more depth to his scholarly output and personal motivations, though these remain limited in the materials currently available.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Basari D. Mapupuno
- Paisalin P.D. Tago
- Marawi Siege

References

- According to official Mindanao State University (MSU) System records and personnel announcements
- According to MSU System news releases and official Facebook page updates regarding the 2025 presidential succession
- According to public statements and press coverage of the meeting between Dr. Paca and President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. in Marawi City, June 2025

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